

How to Use This Appendix

This appendix adds practice exercises, phrase banks, study plans and reference notes aligned with the main guide. Work through one section per study session and review your notes weekly.

Extended Study Material

The following sections were prepared by Mubashir Mehdi for LifeWithBooks to supplement this guide with additional explanations, examples and practice. Work through them after reading the main chapters.

Why Prepositions Are So Difficult

Prepositions are widely considered one of the most challenging aspects of English grammar. Unlike nouns or verbs, prepositions often seem arbitrary - why do we say 'interested in' but 'excited about'? Why 'on Monday' but 'at night'? This book addresses that challenge head-on by organizing prepositions into logical categories and providing the patterns and rules that actually exist beneath the apparent chaos.

Structured Approach to Mastery

The book divides prepositions into clear groups: prepositions of time (at, on, in, by, during, for, since, until), prepositions of place and position (at, on, in, above, below, between, among, behind), prepositions of movement and direction (to, from, into, out of, through, across, along), and abstract or idiomatic prepositions used with specific verbs, adjectives and nouns. Each chapter introduces a small group of prepositions, explains their core meanings with diagrams and natural example sentences, highlights common errors that learners make, and then provides graded exercises - from controlled gap-fills to freer rewriting and translation tasks.

Practice With Full Answer Key

Every exercise comes with a detailed answer key, making the book fully suitable for self-study. Learners can work through it chapter by chapter for a complete course, or dip into specific sections to target their weak areas. The progressive difficulty within each chapter means both intermediate and upper-intermediate learners will find it useful.

Ideal for exam preparation, academic writing improvement, or anyone tired of guessing which preposition to use.

Preposition and Grammar Drills

1. I am interested ___ learning English. (in)
2. She arrived ___ Monday morning. (on)
3. We met ___ the airport. (at)
4. He has lived here ___ 2020. (since)
5. The report is ___ the manager's desk. (on)

6. She is good ____ mathematics. (at)
7. Thank you ____ your help. (for)
8. I agree ____ your point. (with)
9. They walked ____ the bridge. (across)
10. We talked ____ the phone for an hour. (on)
11. She is afraid ____ spiders. (of)
12. He apologized ____ being late. (for)
13. This book belongs ____ me. (to)
14. We succeeded ____ finishing on time. (in)
15. She depends ____ public transport. (on)
16. I look forward ____ meeting you. (to)
17. He insisted ____ paying the bill. (on)
18. They laughed ____ the joke. (at)
19. She specializes ____ international law. (in)
20. We waited ____ the bus for twenty minutes. (for)
21. The picture hangs ____ the wall. (on)
22. She is ____ home now. (at)
23. We travel ____ train when possible. (by)
24. He jumped ____ the swimming pool. (into)
25. The cat hid ____ the sofa. (under)
26. She stood ____ me in the queue. (behind)
27. The office is ____ the bank and the library. (between)
28. They discussed the plan ____ detail. (in)
29. I will see you ____ the weekend. (at / on - both common)
30. She has worked here ____ three years. (for)
31. We drove ____ the tunnel. (through)
32. He fell ____ the stairs. (down)
33. The bird flew ____ the roof. (over)
34. She is ____ charge of the project. (in)
35. We agreed ____ a new deadline. (on)
36. He is married ____ a doctor. (to)
37. She complained ____ the noise. (about)
38. I ran ____ an old friend yesterday. (into)
39. They voted ____ the proposal. (for)
40. We need to focus ____ quality first. (on)

Grammar Reference Notes

1. Present simple for habits and facts: She works in IT. Water boils at 100°C.
2. Present continuous for now and temporary situations: I am studying for an exam this week.
3. Past simple for completed past actions: We finished the project yesterday.
4. Past continuous for background actions: It was raining when I left.
5. Present perfect for life experience and recent past with present relevance: I have visited London twice.
6. Present perfect continuous for duration until now: She has been learning English for three years.
7. Future with will for decisions and predictions: I think it will rain tomorrow.
8. Future with going to for plans: We are going to launch the app next month.
9. First conditional for real possibilities: If you study daily, you will improve.
10. Second conditional for hypothetical present: If I had more time, I would travel more.
11. Third conditional for past hypotheticals: If we had left earlier, we would have arrived on time.
12. Modal must for strong obligation: You must wear safety equipment.
13. Modal should for advice: You should review your notes before the test.

14. Modal might for possibility: The meeting might be delayed.
15. Passive voice when agent is unknown or unimportant: The report was approved yesterday.
16. Relative clauses with who/which/that: The engineer who led the team received an award.
17. Reported speech backshift: She said she was tired.
18. Articles: a/an for first mention; the for known items; zero article for general plural nouns.
19. Countable vs uncountable: many ideas / much information.
20. Gerunds after certain verbs: I enjoy reading; He avoided answering.

Extended Reading Passage

Read aloud once for gist, then again for vocabulary. Underline five new words and write your own summary paragraph.

Effective language learning depends on consistent exposure and active use. Many learners spend years studying grammar rules without speaking regularly, which creates a gap between knowledge and performance. Research suggests that daily contact with meaningful input - podcasts, articles, conversations, films with subtitles - builds the mental patterns needed for fluent speech. Output matters too: writing short paragraphs, recording yourself, and joining discussions force your brain to retrieve vocabulary under time pressure, which strengthens long-term memory.

Another key factor is error tolerance. Advanced speakers make mistakes; the goal is communication, not perfection. Keep a personal error log: note recurring problems (prepositions, articles, word order) and review them weekly. Pair study with real tasks - emails, presentations, travel - so new language serves a purpose. Finally, set measurable goals: learn twenty collocations this month, hold a ten-minute conversation twice a week, or finish one graded reader. Small, steady progress beats occasional marathon sessions.

Error Correction Exercises

Find and fix the mistake in each sentence. Answers are in parentheses.

1. She don't like spicy food. (doesn't)
2. I have been to Paris last year. (went - specific past time)
3. He is more taller than his brother. (taller - remove more)
4. We discussed about the problem. (discussed the - no about)
5. She suggested me to apply. (suggested that I apply)
6. I am agree with you. (I agree)
7. He explained me the rules. (explained the rules to me)
8. The informations are useful. (information - uncountable)
9. I look forward to meet you. (to meeting)
10. She is married with a lawyer. (married to)
11. I have a news for you. (some news - uncountable)
12. He did a mistake. (made a mistake)
13. We must to finish today. (must finish)
14. She is boring of the lecture. (bored by / bored with)
15. I am here since three hours. (have been here for)
16. He said that he will come. (would come - reported speech)
17. The children is playing outside. (children are)
18. I am used to wake up early. (used to waking up)
19. She is responsible of the team. (responsible for)
20. We need discuss this later. (need to discuss)

Sentence Building Practice

Combine the prompts into full sentences. Example: [weather / bad / stay home]

-> Because the weather was bad, we decided to stay home.

1. [deadline / tight / work / weekend]
2. [not familiar / software / ask / colleague]
3. [train / delayed / arrive / late]
4. [research / shows / exercise / improves / memory]
5. [although / tired / finish / assignment]
6. [if / more time / learn / second language]
7. [manager / praised / team / hard work]
8. [before / presentation / rehearse / twice]
9. [customer / complained / slow / service]
10. [since / moved / city / made / friends]
11. [unless / study / regularly / forget / vocabulary]
12. [despite / rain / match / continued]
13. [recommend / book / anyone / interested / history]
14. [while / waiting / bus / read / article]
15. [as soon as / hear / news / call / me]

Four-Week Study Plan

Use this plan to study Preposition Focus on Building Mastery in daily 30-45 minute sessions.

Week 1 - Foundations

Days 1-2: Skim the guide and list unknown words. Days 3-4: Study one core chapter and summarize it in your own words. Days 5-7: Do practice exercises aloud; record yourself if possible.

Week 2 - Active Practice

Days 8-10: Focus on your weakest section; redo examples without looking. Days 11-12: Explain the material to a friend or aloud alone. Days 13-14: Mixed review from all sections.

Week 3 - Real Usage

Days 15-17: Use new language in real tasks. Days 18-19: Read or listen to authentic English on the same topic. Days 20-21: Write 300 words applying what you learned.

Week 4 - Consolidation

Days 22-24: Timed practice under exam or workplace conditions. Days 25-26: Fix weak areas using notes and answer keys. Days 27-28: Final review before moving to advanced material.

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